

January

2



1975

Mysterious monarchs

US biologist Kenneth C Brugger first documented the winter location of the monarch butterfly in the mountains of Mexico. He found forested slopes covered with millions of butterflies that had travelled south from the USA and Canada for more than 4,800 km (3,000 miles).

Also on this day

1492 The surrender of the Spanish city of Granada to Christian forces marked the end of more than 700 years of Islamic rule in Spain.

1929 Canada and the USA agreed to redirect the Niagara River to reduce erosion and protect the Niagara Falls.

1963 The Viet Cong won its first major victory at the Battle of Ap Bac during the Vietnam War.

2004

Stardust sample

Flying close to Comet Wild 2, NASA's *Stardust* space probe grabbed samples of dust left in the comet's wake. It became the first-ever spacecraft to take a sample from a comet and bring it back to Earth.



1879

Cricket hat-trick

Nicknamed the Demon Bowler, Australian cricketer Fred Spofforth bowled out three English batsmen with three balls in a row. This was the first-ever hat-trick in test cricket, at a match held at the Melbourne Cricket Ground in Australia.



Born this day

1920 Isaac Asimov, US author and biochemist. He was a celebrated science-fiction writer and editor of around 500 books about space, science, and robots. His most famous works are the *Foundation* and *Robot* series.